conscientious objection and Jordan's full embrace of the Nazi philosophy. Heisenberg condemned the bewilderingly idiotic "Deutsche Physik" of Stark and Lenard, and helped von Laue in successfully ending the campaign against quantum physics and relativity in Germany. But Heisenberg also remained in Hitler's Reich largely out of a sense of obligation and patriotism, and morally compromised himself by collaborating with the Nazis while simultaneously hiding behind the "apolitical" nature of science. He had been offered many positions across the United States and the UK in the six years between Hitler's rise to power and the outbreak of war—most recently, during his tour of the States in the summer of 1939. Heisenberg turned them all down, insisting only that "Germany needs me." While Heisenberg was not a Nazi, he left very little doubt about the depths of his loyalty to Germany, no matter who was leading the country—leaving a physics summer school in Michigan early, he said he had to return to Germany for "machine gun practice in the Bavarian Alps."

Shortly after the war started, Heisenberg was (unsurprisingly) chosen as one of the leaders of the German nuclear program. The project floundered almost from the start. Heisenberg's grasp on experimental physics had been poor since his student days in Munich, and he made simple errors in calculating the relevant quantities—"though a brilliant theoretician [Heisenberg] was always very casual about numbers," his former colleague Rudolf Peierls recalled. Communication breakdowns and clerical errors plagued the project; interference from the Nazi scientific bureaucracy forced personnel decisions based on political beliefs rather than scientific talent. And a crucial realization—that purified graphite could be used to moderate and control nuclear chain reactions—escaped the attention of Heisenberg and his colleagues. After dismissing the possibilities of impure graphite, they instead focused their efforts on a much more rare and expensive moderator, heavy water, which slowed their progress even further. By 1942, just as the American bomb program was building up steam, the German program had come to a nearly total halt. In an Army Ordnance conference in Berlin in 1942, Heisenberg told his Nazi superiors that although it was unlikely that a bomb could be completed before the end of the war, a nuclear reactor held promise as a new power source for the Reich's war engine. Shortly thereafter, Heisenberg was made the de facto head of the nuclear program in Germany, despite the fact that he had never